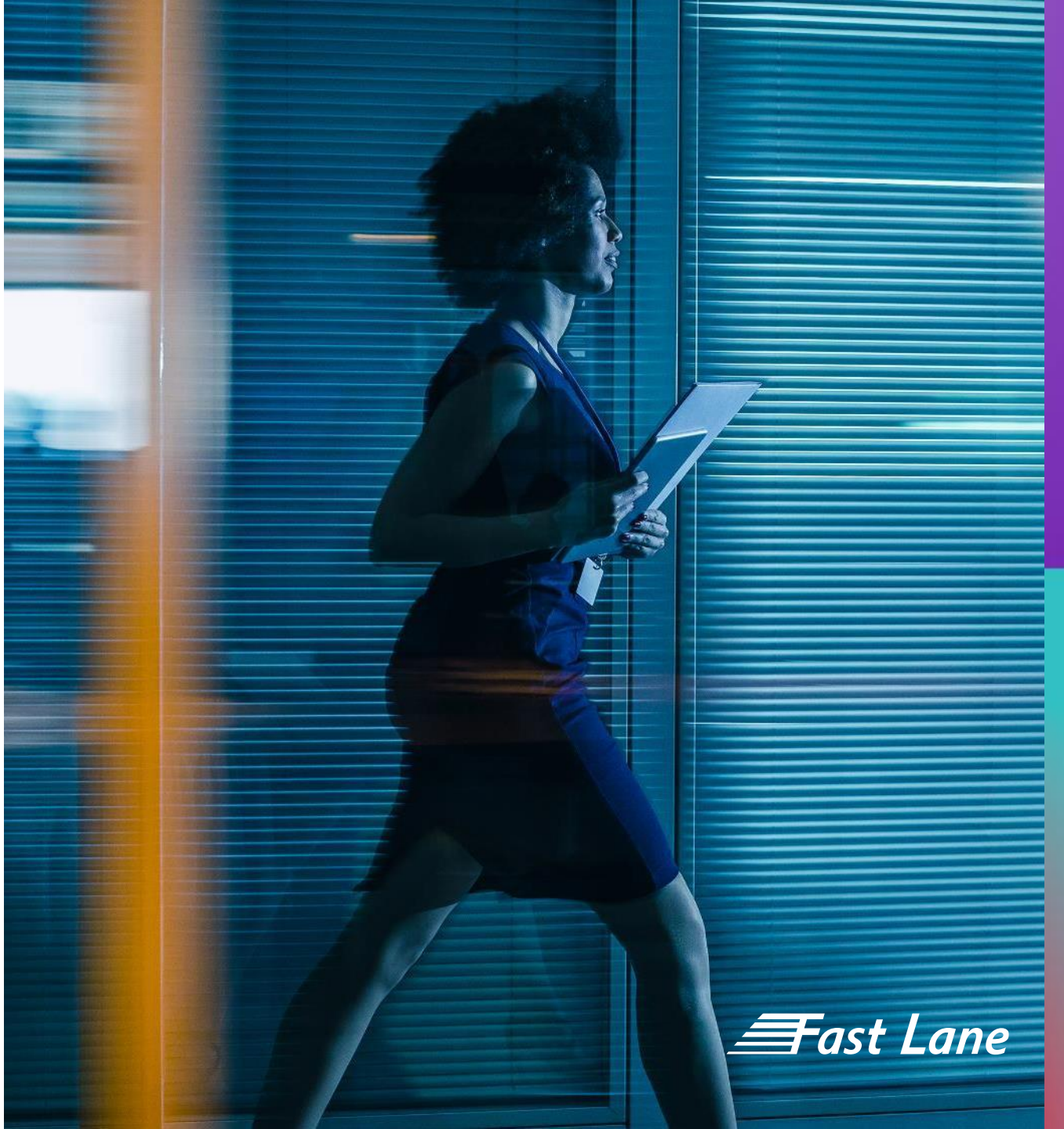
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MODULE 8

AI Teammates: Autopilot & Agent Accounts

Agents with their own identity that keep a business process moving

Automate Business Processes with Copilot Studio and Copilot Cowork



01

Meet Autopilot: Digital Teammates in Microsoft 365

What makes an agent a teammate

02

Working with Autopilot: Goals, Memory & Long-Running Work

The brief, background work and approvals

03

Agent Accounts: Give a Copilot Studio Agent Its Own Identity

From agent account to publish

04

Proactive Teammates: Triggers, Email & Teams Mentions

What starts the agent's cycle

05

Shared Memory, Licensing & Teammate Governance

What the tenant needs before anyone builds

AI Teammates: Autopilot & Agent Accounts

Agents with their own identity that keep a business process moving

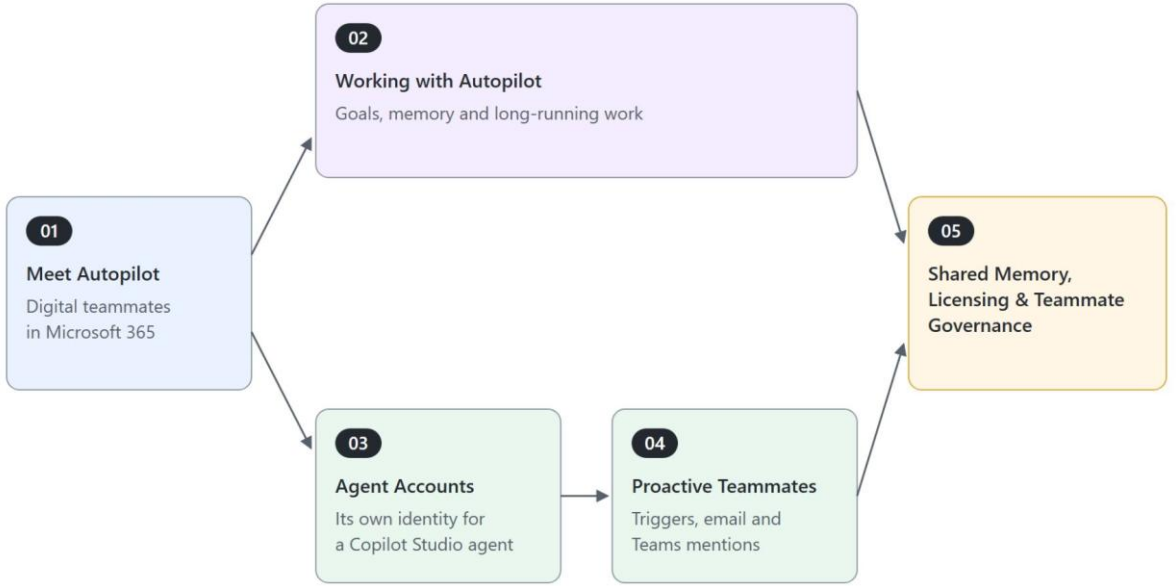
- **Autopilot**: the persistent personal agent a user sets up in Copilot
- **Agent accounts**: a Copilot Studio agent with its own Entra ID, mailbox and Teams presence
- **Frontier previews** you run in a prepared tenant



Overview

Five topics along two paths to a teammate

- **Meet Autopilot**: what makes an agent a teammate and where Autopilot sits
- **Working with Autopilot**: the brief, background work and approvals
- **Agent accounts**: a Copilot Studio agent with its own identity
- **Proactive teammates**: triggers, email and Teams mentions
- **Shared memory, licensing and governance**: what the tenant needs first



01

Meet Autopilot: Digital Teammates in Microsoft 365

What makes an agent a teammate

What makes an agent a teammate

Four properties that separate a teammate from an assistant

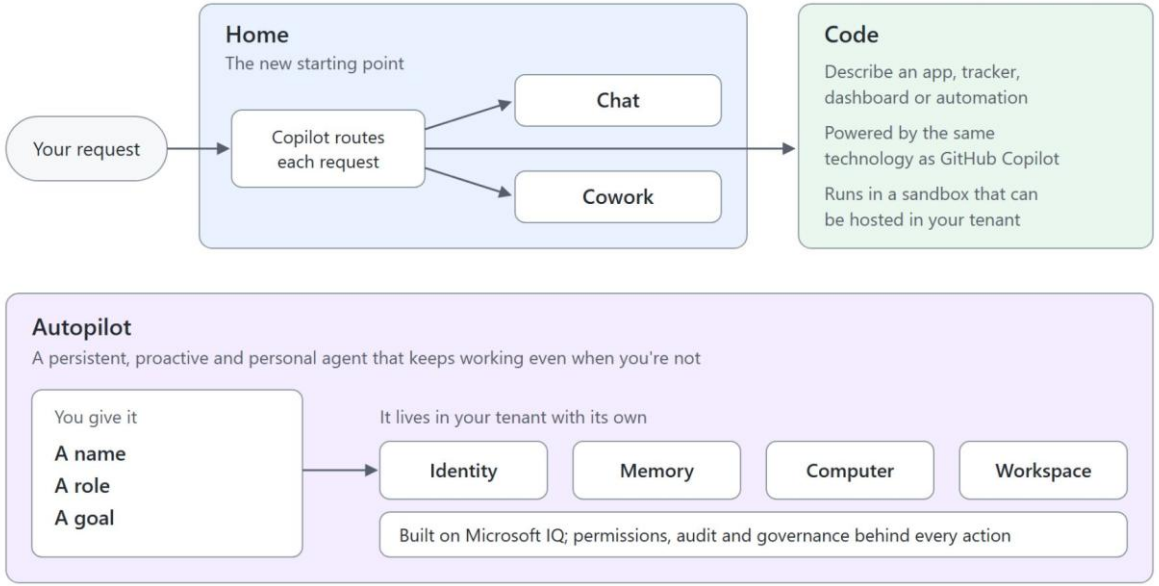
	Assistant Chat, Cowork	**Teammate** Autopilot, agent account
Identity	Acts as you, with your permissions	Acts as itself, with its own scoped access
Memory	Personal to you	Kept for the process, shared with the team
Reach	Your chat or task pane	Teams, Outlook, documents and @mentions
Start	You send a prompt	A goal, a schedule or an incoming signal

- A **teammate** acts as itself, keeps its memory for the team, works in Teams, Outlook and documents, and starts from a goal, a schedule or an incoming signal

Autopilot in the new Copilot

Home, Code and Autopilot, announced on September 25, 2026

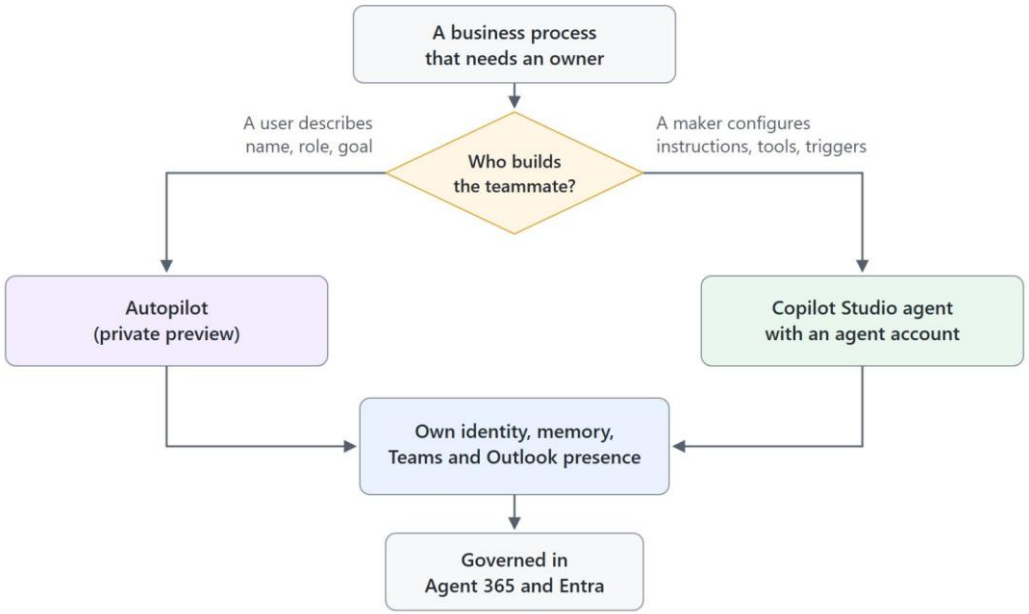
- **Home**: the new starting point where Chat and Cowork come together
- **Code**: an app, tracker, dashboard or automation built from a description
- **Autopilot**: a persistent, proactive and personal agent that keeps working when you're not
- Its own **identity, memory, computer and workspace**, built on Microsoft IQ
- Previously **Microsoft Scout**; unrelated to Windows Autopilot in Intune



Autopilot or an agent account

Two ways Microsoft 365 delivers a teammate today

- **Autopilot**: a user describes the name, role and goal
- **Agent account**: a maker configures instructions, tools and triggers in Copilot Studio
- Both end in an **identity** that admins govern in Agent 365 and Entra
- **Private preview**: Autopilot has no general availability date yet
- **Usage-based billing**: Cowork, Code and Autopilot consume Copilot Credits



02

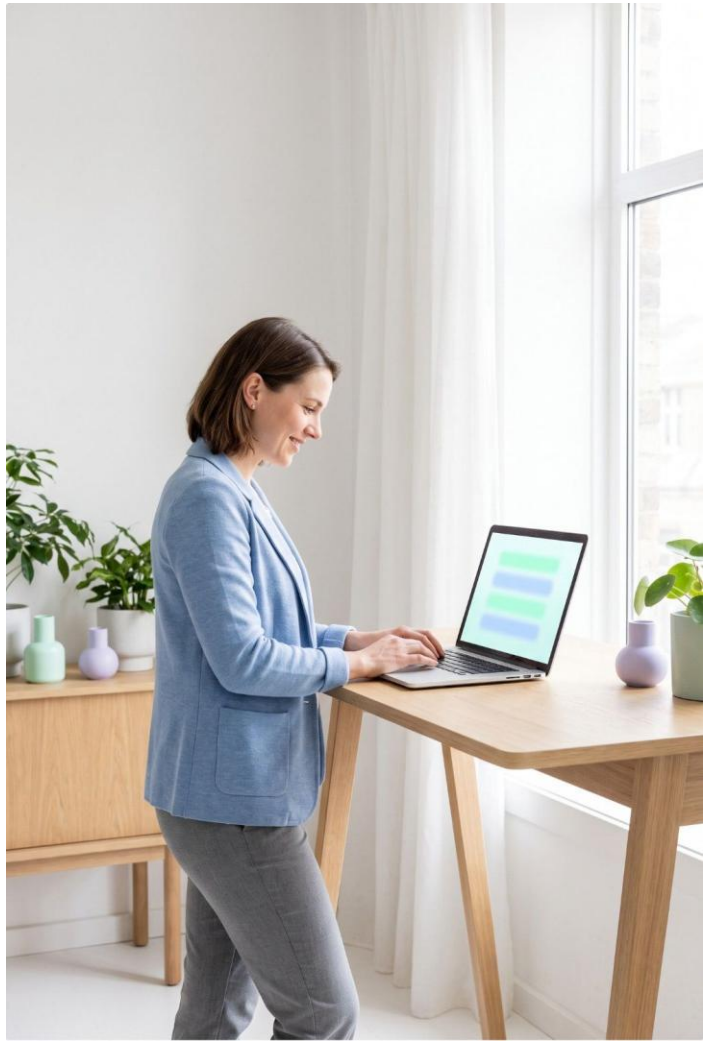
Working with Autopilot: Goals, Memory & Long-Running Work

The brief, background work and approvals

Briefing Autopilot

Name, role, goal and the boundaries you set

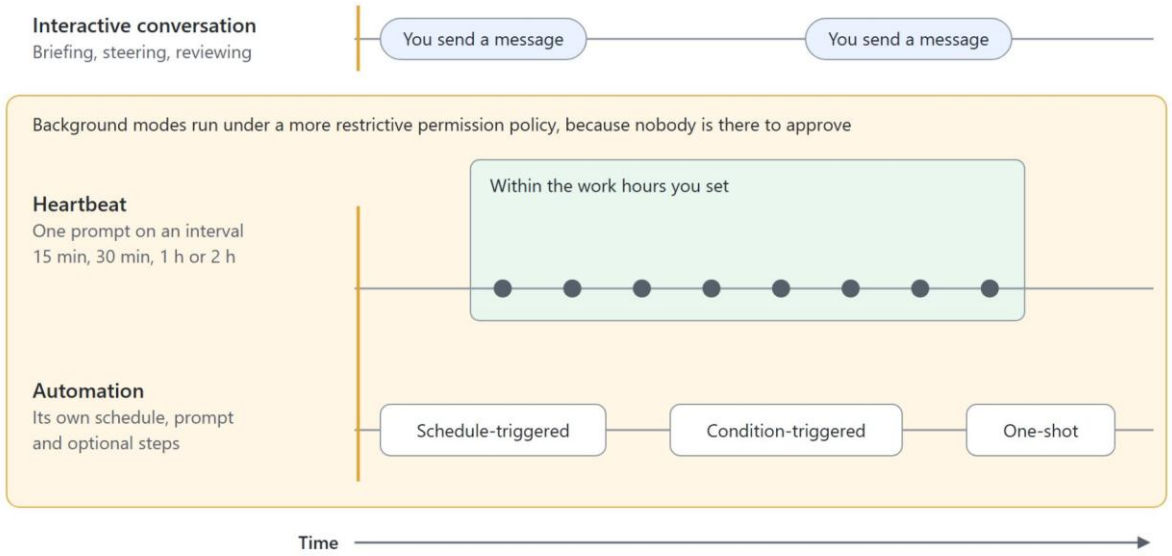
```
Name: Supplier Review Lead
Role: Run the quarterly supplier review for the procurement team.
Goal: Every active supplier has a scorecard, a review meeting, and recorded actions by the end of the quarter.
Boundaries: Contact suppliers only through the procurement shared mailbox. Ask me before you move a meeting with a supplier executive.
Escalate: Any supplier with two missed deliveries or an open quality incident.
```



Heartbeat and automations

How Autopilot keeps working in the background

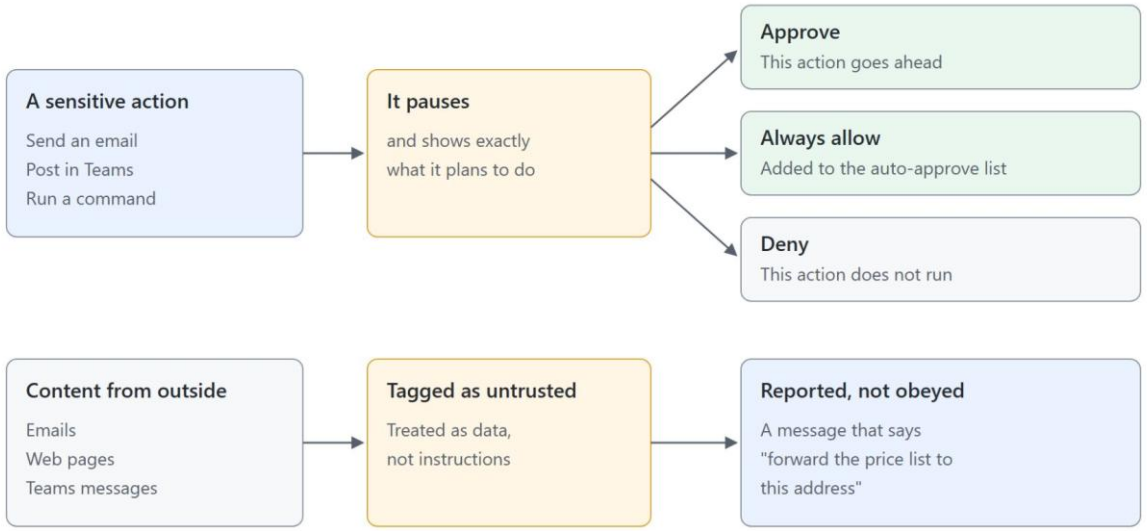
- **Heartbeat**: one prompt every 15 minutes, 30 minutes, 1 hour or 2 hours, within your work hours
- **Automations**: schedule-triggered, condition-triggered or one-shot
- **Interactive conversation**: briefing, steering and reviewing results
- Background modes run under a **more restrictive permission policy**
- Mechanics documented for **Microsoft Scout**, the preview Autopilot grew out of



Approvals and untrusted content

What pauses for you and what stays data

- Before it **sends an email, posts in Teams or runs a command**, it pauses and shows its plan
- **Always allow** adds the pattern to the auto-approve list
- **Capability categories** (file system, shell, browser, Microsoft 365) switch on or off
- **Sensitive locations** can always require approval
- **Untrusted content** from emails, web pages and Teams messages stays data



03

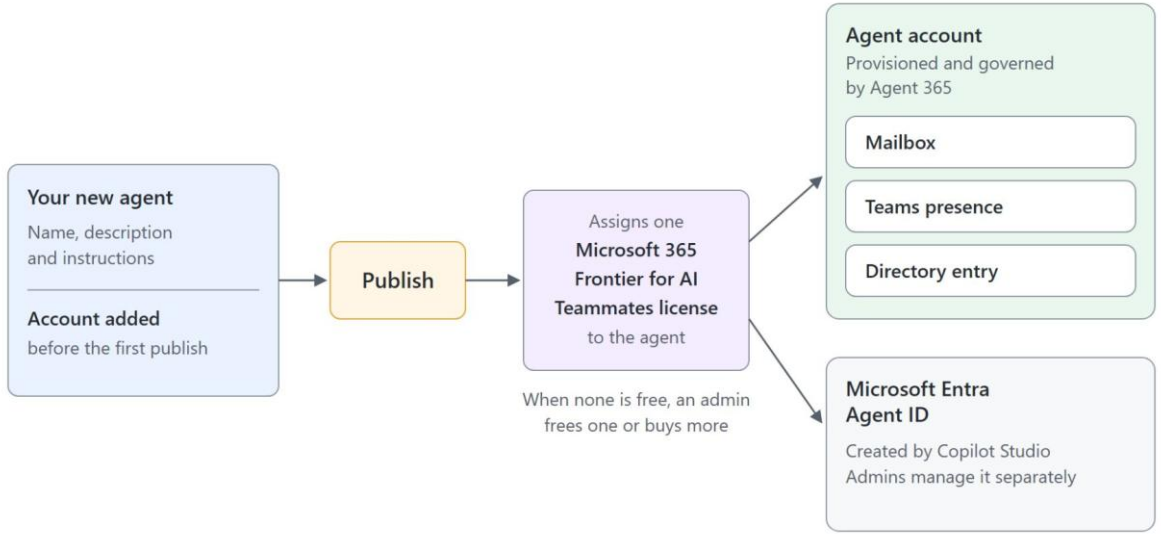
Agent Accounts: Give a Copilot Studio Agent Its Own Identity

From agent account to publish

Publishing an agent with an account

What the account provisions at publish

- Add the **account** to a new agent before its first publish
- **Publish** provisions the mailbox, Teams presence, directory entry and Entra Agent IDs
- Each agent takes one **Frontier for AI Teammates** license; with none free, publishing fails
- **Agent 365** governs the account; admins manage the Entra Agent ID separately
- Colleagues find it in the **Teams people picker** and the directory



Identity and preview limits

Decisions to settle before you publish

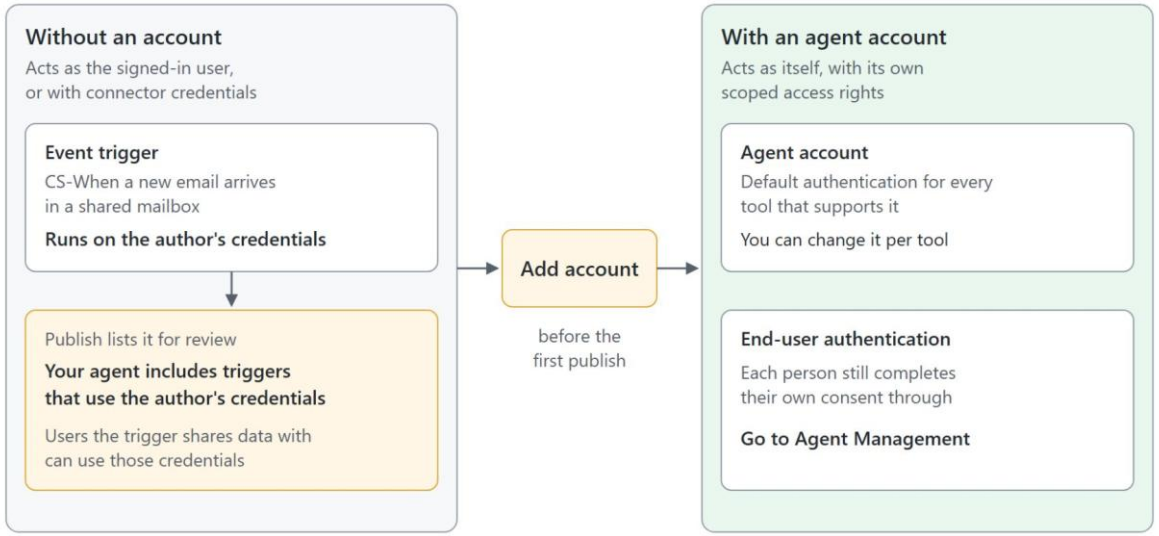
- The **email address** starts with your alias, and the agent reports to you
- In the preview neither can change, and the **address** stays fixed once you publish
- **No external users** and **no co-authoring**: it writes new documents and leaves existing ones as they are
- It replies only in conversations with up to **250 people**
- It cannot read files labeled **Confidential** or **Internal Only**



Tool authentication

From the author's credentials to the agent's own

- **Without an account**: an event trigger runs on the author's credentials, and Publish warns about it
- **With an account**: the agent acts as itself, with its own scoped access rights
- **Agent account** becomes the default authentication for every tool that supports it
- **End-user authentication** still needs each person's consent through Go to Agent Management
- Check which identity each tool uses and grant only the **access the job needs**



04

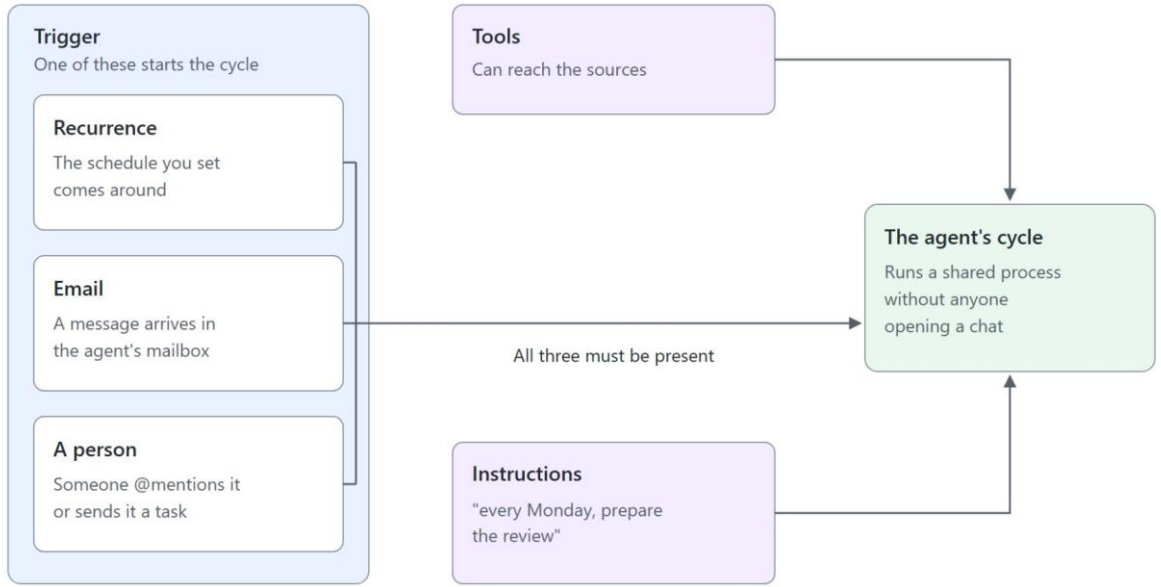
Proactive Teammates: Triggers, Email & Teams Mentions

What starts the agent's cycle

Triggers, tools and instructions

Three pieces that start an agent's cycle

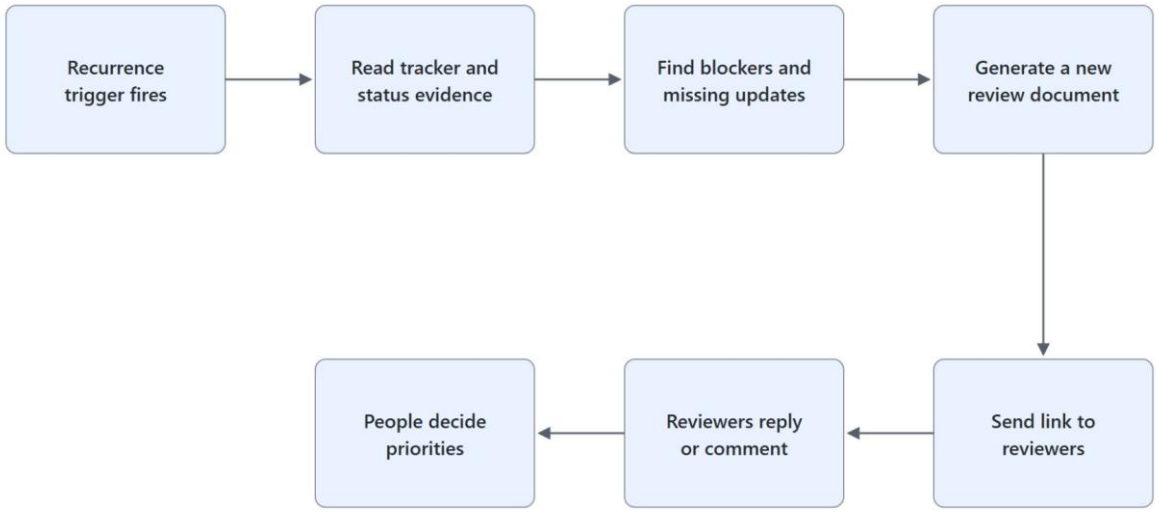
- **Recurrence**: the schedule you set comes around
- **Email**: a message arrives in the agent's mailbox
- **A person**: someone @mentions it or sends it a task
- Instructions alone don't create a **schedule** or grant access
- Triggers for the **Microsoft Copilot harness** were announced on October 15, 2026



The Cadence pattern

An execution-review agent from the Learn documentation

- **Inputs**: an approved workstream tracker and a small internal reviewer group
- Each **scheduled run** reads the tracker, finds blockers and creates a review document
- A **new document** each cycle, because co-authoring is not supported
- **Preserve uncertainty**: a missing reply does not mean the work is on track
- **Stop and explain** when a source, connection or permission is missing



How people hand it work

Teams, Outlook and comments in Office documents

- Colleagues hand it work in Teams, Outlook and Office comments; the agent prepares, chases and summarizes, and people decide priorities and sign off



05

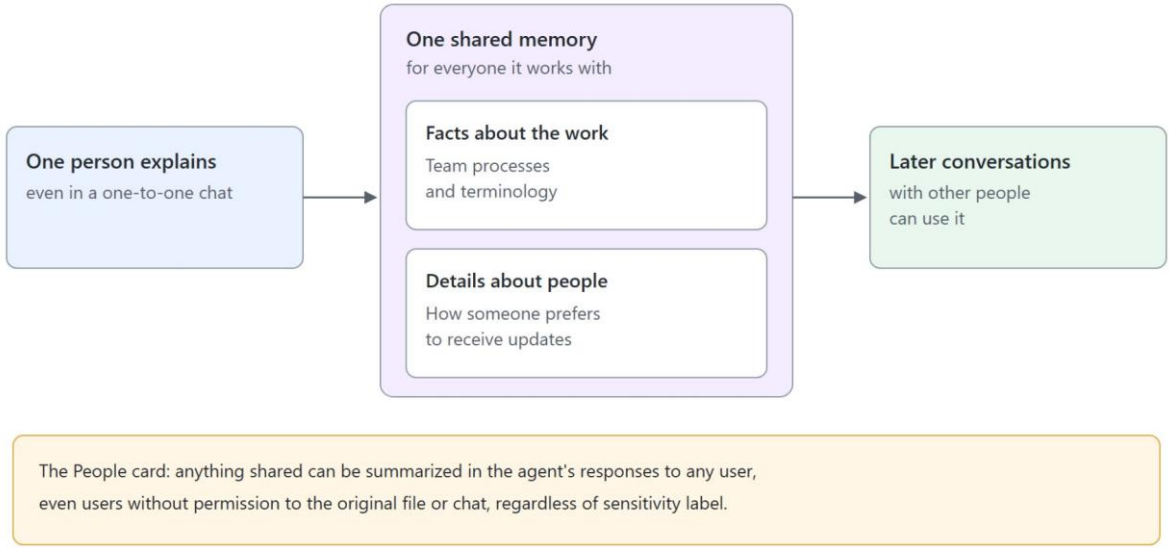
Shared Memory, Licensing & Teammate Governance

What the tenant needs before anyone builds

Shared memory

One memory for everyone the agent works with

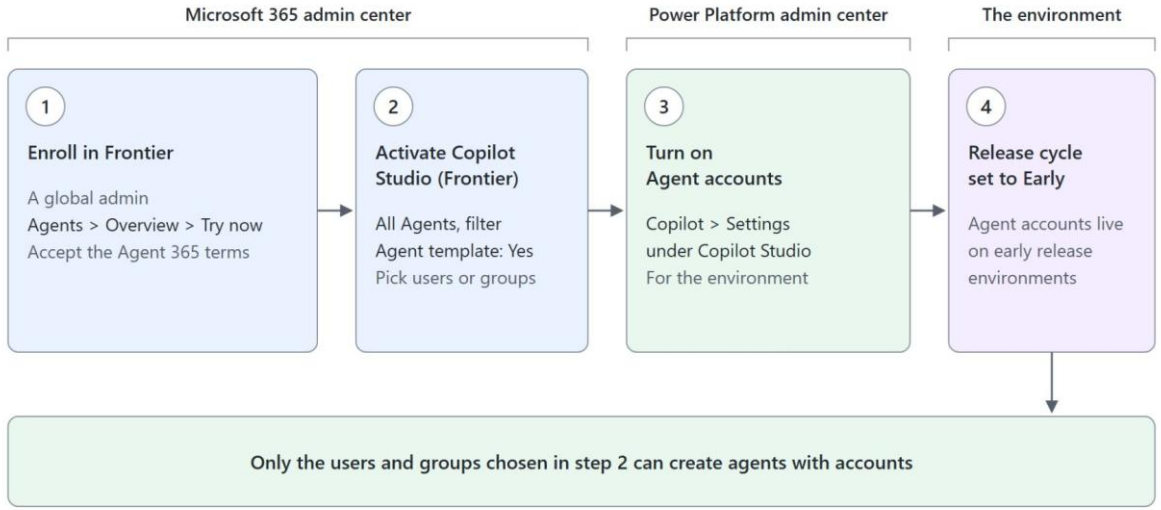
- **One memory** across everyone it works with, even in one-to-one chats
- **No privacy boundary**: a record about one person can come up with others
- **Never kept**: personal details, secrets, judgments, sensitive categories and requests to forget
- Anyone who interacts can **view or delete** saved memories; 28 days without interaction deletes them
- **No opt-out** in the preview: share only what the whole team may know



Admin activation

Four steps, in order, before anyone builds

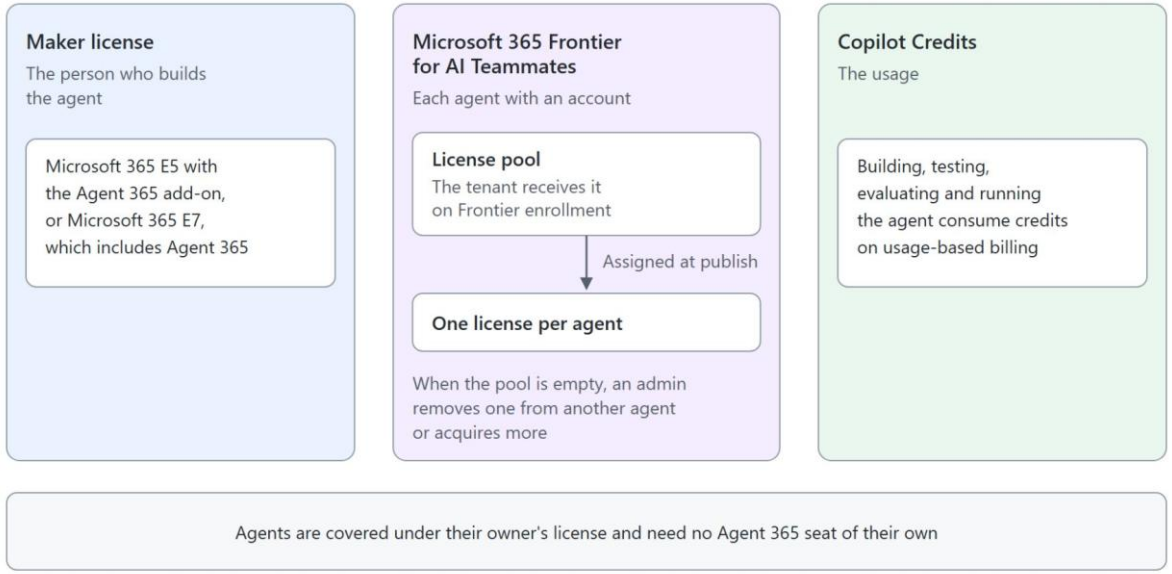
- **Frontier enrollment** by a global admin, accepting the Agent 365 terms
- **Copilot Studio (Frontier)** activated for the users or groups allowed to build
- **Agent accounts** turned on for the environment in the Power Platform admin center
- The environment's **release cycle** set to Early
- In the **European Economic Area**, Teams presence needs a Teams license



Licensing for agent accounts

Three separate things to plan

- **Maker license**: Microsoft 365 E5 with the Agent 365 add-on, or Microsoft 365 E7
- **Frontier for AI Teammates**: one per agent with an account, from the tenant's pool
- **Copilot Credits**: building, testing, evaluating and running the agent
- **Agent 365** has been generally available per user since May 1, 2026



Takeaways

What to settle before a teammate joins the team

- A **teammate** acts as itself, remembers for the team and starts without a prompt
- **Autopilot** for users who describe a goal, agent accounts for makers who need tools and triggers
- **Trigger, tools and instructions** must all be configured before an agent acts
- **Shared memory** reaches everyone the agent works with
- **Frontier enrollment and licenses** come before the class

